

content



Definition of sentence



Classification of sentences



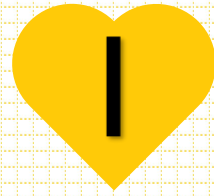
Elements of a sentence



Requirements of a correct sentence



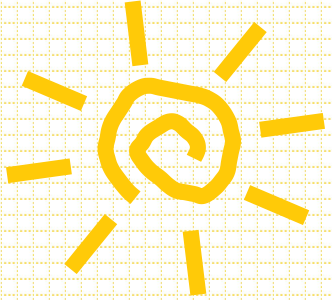
Requirements of an effective sentence



Definition of *sentence*



What is a sentence?



A sentence is said to be a group of words capable of expressing **a complete thought**, whether a statement, command, question or exclamation.

Eg. **The table is dirty.**

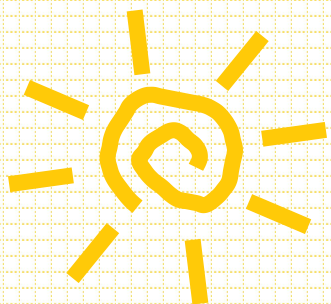
Give me the book please.

How much are they going to pay you?

What a handsome guy!



What is a sentence?



components of a sentence (Some terms):

subject (the noun/ pronoun part)

主语

predicate (the verb part)

谓语

object

宾语

attribute

定语

complement

补语

adverbial modifier

状语





Classification of sentences



Grammatical classification (As to functions)



declarative sentences

陈述句

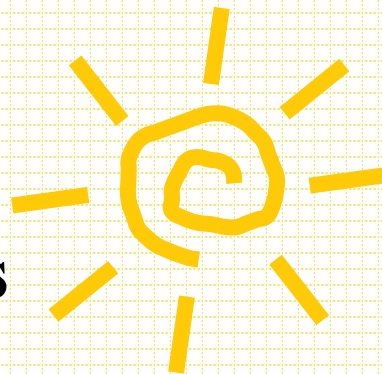
imperative sentences

祈使句



interrogative sentences

疑问句



exclamatory sentences

感叹句



Can you give some example sentences?



Grammatical classification (As to structures)



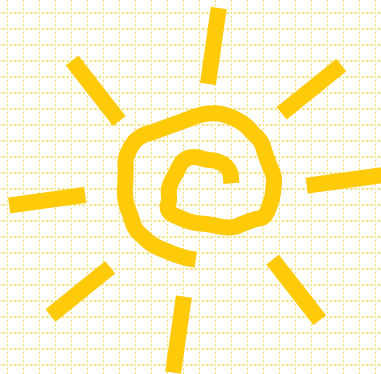
simple sentences

简单句



compound sentences

并列句



complex sentences

复合句



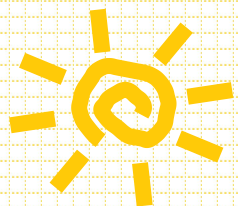
**compound-complex
sentences**

并列复合句





Grammatical classification (As to structures)

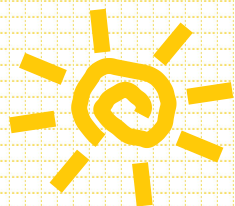


Simple sentences 简单句

- a sentence having no coordinate clauses (并列句) or subordinated clauses (从句)
- also called an *independent clause*, contains a subject and a verb, and it expresses *a complete thought*.



Grammatical classification (As to structures)

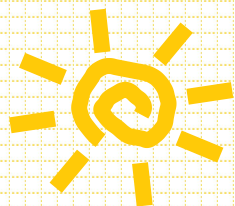


Simple sentences 简单句

- A. Some students like to study in the mornings.
- B. Juan and Arturo play football every afternoon.
- C. Alicia goes to the library and studies every day.



Grammatical classification (As to structures)

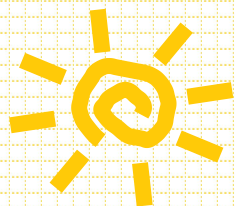


Compound sentences 并列句

- a sentence composed of at least two coordinate independent clauses (并列独立分句)
- a sentence containing more than two subjects and predicate verbs, usually **joined by a coordinator**. The coordinators(并列词) are as follows: *for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so*. Except for very short sentences, coordinators are always **preceded by a comma**.



Grammatical classification (As to structures)



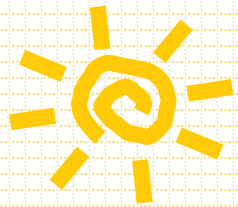
Compound sentences 并列句

A. I tried to speak Spanish, **and** my friend tried to speak English.

B. Alejandro played football, **so** Maria went shopping.



Grammatical classification (As to structures)

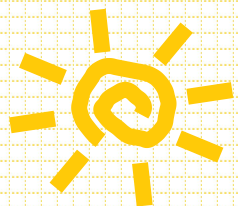


1. I visited the beach. And I got a really bad sunburn. two simple sentences
2. I visited the beach, and I got a really bad sunburn a compound sentence
3. I visited the beach and got a really bad sunburn. a simple sentence

compound predicate



Grammatical classification (As to structures)



Complex sentences 复合句

- independent clause 独立句子
- dependent clause 非独立句子

When we buy his birthday cake, we have to make sure it's lemon.

not stand on its own, not
express a complete idea

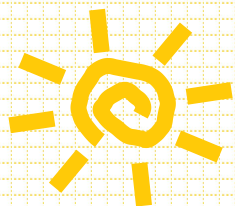
dependent clause--- subordinate clause

stand on its own,
express a complete idea

independent clause--- main clause



Grammatical classification (As to structures)

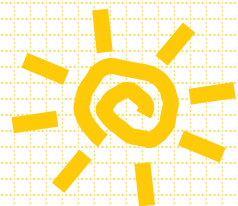


Complex sentences 复合句

- a sentence composed of at least one main clause and one subordinate clauses
- at least one component of the sentence is in the form of a simple sentence
- an independent clause joined by one or more dependent clauses. **A complex sentence always has a subordinator(从属连词) such as *because, since, after, although, or when* or a relative pronoun such as *that, who, or which*.**
- **1 independent clause + dependent clause(s)**



Grammatical classification (As to structures)

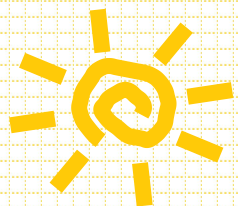


Complex sentences 复合句

- A. **When** he handed in his homework, he forgot to give the teacher the last page.
- B. The teacher returned the homework **after** she noticed the error.
- C. The students are studying **because** they have a test tomorrow.



Grammatical classification (As to forms)



Compound- complex sentences 并列复合句

- complex = 1 independent + dependent(s)
- compound = independents
- compound- complex = independents + dependent(s)

After the storm passed, I went outside, and I picked flowers.

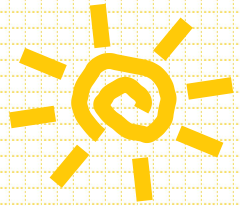
dependent clause

independent clause

independent clause



Grammatical classification (As to forms)



Compound- complex sentences 并列复合句

After the storm passed, I went outside, and I picked flowers because they were beautiful.

dependent clause

dependent clause

independent clause

independent clause



Rhetorical classification (As to arrangement of elements)



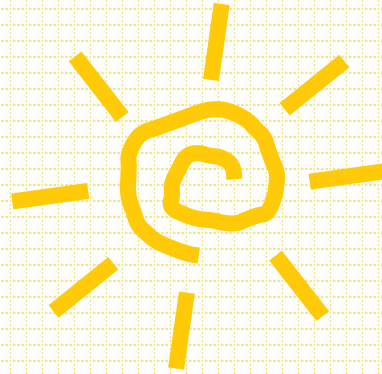
periodic sentences

圆周句



loose sentences

松散句



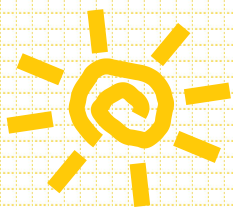
balanced sentences

对偶句/ 平行句





Rhetorical classification (As to arrangement of elements)



Periodic sentences 圆周句

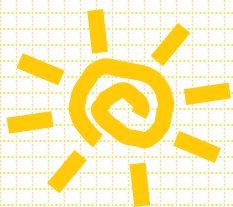
- The periodic sentence is one in which **no complete thought can be got until the end is reached.**

A. Although he had done all he could to come early, he missed the lecture.

B. The great question that has never been answered, and which I have not yet been able to answer despite my thirty years of research into the feminine soul, is this, “What does a woman want?”



Rhetorical classification (As to arrangement of elements)



Loose sentences 松散句

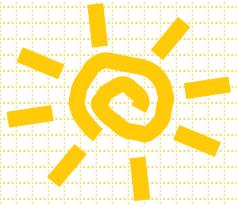
- The loose sentence is the opposite one of the periodic sentence since in the loose sentence **the most important part comes first, i.e. the main idea is stated near or at the beginning of the sentence.** (Typical English thinking!)

A. He missed the lecture although he had done all he could to come early.

B. Read the letter again if you have time.



Rhetorical classification (As to arrangement of elements)



Balanced sentences 对偶句

- A balanced sentence is one in which **parallel structure is used to express parallel ideas**. Balanced sentences can **give emphasis and variety** to our writing.

1) *The more you write, the more you can write.*

2) *They died for liberty; they died for us.*

3) *What is written without effort is in general read without pleasure.*

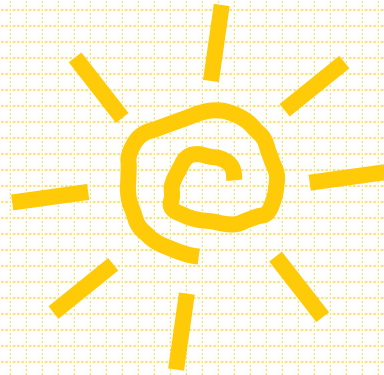


Length classification (As to arrangement of elements)



Short sentences

短句



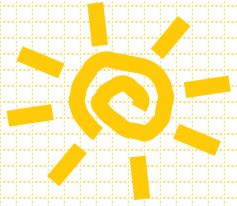
Long sentences

长句

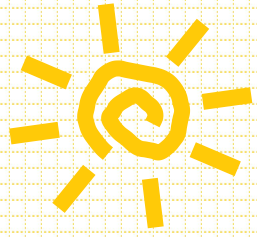




Length classification (As to arrangement of elements)

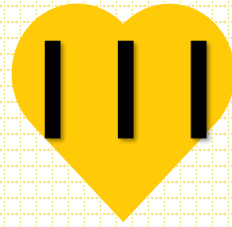


- Short sentences are usually *emphatic*, whereas long sentences are capable of *expressing complex ideas with precision*, because it may *contain many modifiers*.
- Short sentences are suitable for the *presentation of important facts and ideas*, and long sentences for the *explanation of views and theories, or the description of things with many details*.



Conclusion

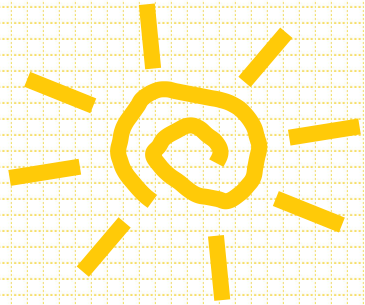
- Various sentence structures have been discussed. The basic principle is that the structure should fit the idea being expressed.
- In other words, the idea determines the choice of the structure, not the other way round.



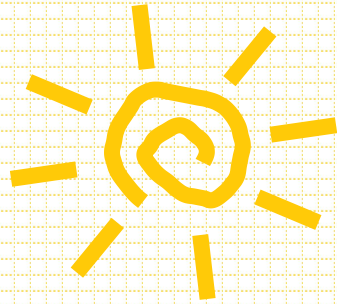
Elements of a Sentence



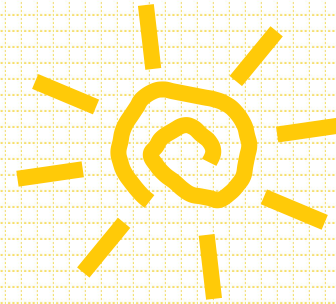
Elements of a sentence



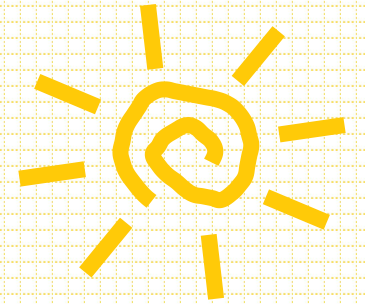
**Completeness
in structure**



**A capital letter
at the
beginning**



**A terminal
punctuation
at the end**



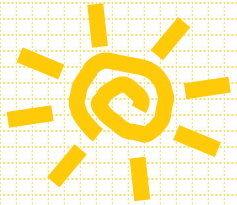
**Expressing a
complete
idea**



Requirements of a Correct Sentence



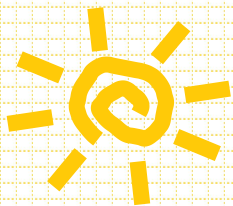
Requirements of a correct sentence



1. completeness in structure
2. the right subject
3. agreement between the subject and the predicate verb
4. agreement between pronoun and antecedent
5. clear pronoun reference
6. ending sentences with full stops
7. joining clauses with conjunctions
8. a main clause in a complex sentence
9. proper use of comparisons
10. correct use of the tense



Requirements of a correct sentence



1. Completeness in structure

The typical English sentence follows this pattern: Subject + predicate

He is tall. / It is raining.

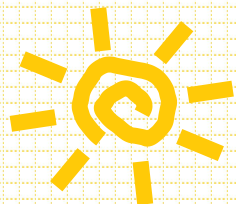
Her sister is twenty years old.

They have only one child.

The old man takes a walk in the park every day.



Requirements of a correct sentence



1. Completeness in structure

Attention:

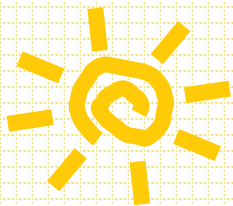
In a simple Chinese sentence we sometimes do not find a subject or a verb.

Because of **the first language interference**, beginners sometimes write sentences without a subject or a verb.

Therefore, the first thing beginners should learn is **to check their own sentences to see whether they have the essential elements.**



Requirements of a correct sentence



1. Completeness in structure

Common errors--- fragments (incomplete sentences 句子残缺/不完整句):

A fragment is a part of sentence (such as a phrase or dependant/ subordinate clause) which begins with a capital letter and ends as a sentence does.

所谓完整的句子是指一个句子必须有基本的主谓宾成分。若将句子的某一修饰语当作一个完整的句子，就会导致残缺句（Fragments）。如：

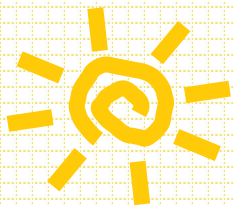
1. 缺主语

(误) If we want our country to be rich and strong, **mostly depend on education.**

(正) If we want our country to be rich and strong, **we** must depend on education.



Requirements of a correct sentence



1. Completeness in structure

Common errors--- fragments (incomplete sentences 句子残缺/不完整句):

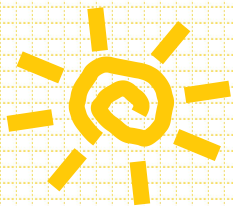
2. 缺谓语

(误) Many people who get married before they are mature enough.

(正) Many people who get married before they are mature enough **are faced**
with many unexpected problems.



Requirements of a correct sentence



1. Completeness in structure

Common errors--- fragments (incomplete sentences 句子残缺/不完整句):

3. 缺关系代词

(误) There are a lot of students like to read aloud in the morning.

(正) There are a lot of students **who** like to read aloud in the morning.

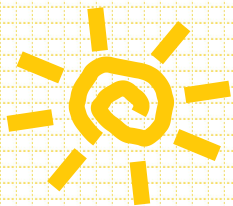
4. 缺不定式

(误) Become a biologist isn't an easy thing for me.

(正) **To** become a biologist isn't an easy thing for me.



Requirements of a correct sentence



1. Completeness in structure

Common errors--- fragments (incomplete sentences 句子残缺/不完整句):

Attention: fragment-like sentences are often used:

1) as exclamations

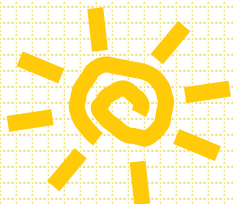
2) in spoken English

3) as transitions

4) for emphasis and vividness



Requirements of a correct sentence



1. Completeness in structure

Common errors--- fragments (incomplete sentences 句子残缺/不完整句):

Attention: fragment-like sentences are often used:

1) as exclamations

Oh! Nonsense! Well done!

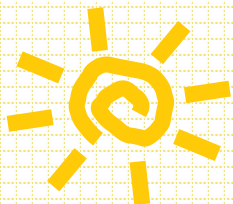
What a day!

How kind of you!

Susan a singer!?



Requirements of a correct sentence



1. Completeness in structure

Common errors--- fragments (incomplete sentences 句子残缺/不完整句):

Attention: fragment-like sentences are often used:

2) in spoken English

A: how about this?

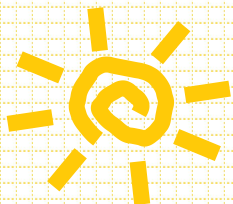
B: very good!

A: Your name and your address, please?

B: All right , here.



Requirements of a correct sentence



1. Completeness in structure

Common errors--- fragments (incomplete sentences 句子残缺/不完整句):

Attention: fragment-like sentences are often used:

3) as transitions

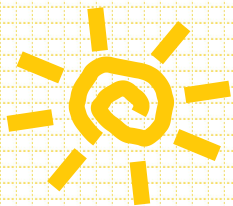
And a final instance, ...

To return from our digression, ...

Now, a few more words about the meeting today.



Requirements of a correct sentence



1. Completeness in structure

Common errors--- fragments (incomplete sentences 句子残缺/不完整句):

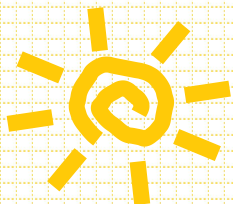
Attention: fragment-like sentences are often used:

4) for emphasis and vividness

There is a price to pay for success. The demanding price of self denial, the price of blood and sweat and tears.



Requirements of a correct sentence



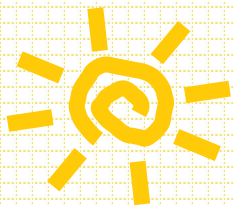
1. Completeness in structure

- 1) How to operate this computer? ✖
- 2) Have lost my key. ✖
- 3) Because he hadn't finished his assignment, so he continued working in the classroom. ✖
- 4) The old man returning home after eight years' absence to find that the neighbors he had known were no longer there. ✖
- 5) Mark Twain whose experience as a sailor on the Mississippi provided him with abundant material for the novels he was to write. ✖

★ let us remember that a normal sentence must contain a subject and a predicate verb.



Requirements of a correct sentence



2. The right subject

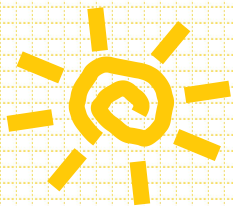
The subject of a sentence should be properly related to the nonfinite verbs—gerunds(动名词), participles(分词) or infinitive(动词不定式)—before it.

Common errors--- misplaced subjects/ dangling modifiers (悬垂修饰语)

悬垂修饰语是与句子的主语不能构成逻辑关系的修饰语。悬垂修饰语可以出现在句中的任意位置，但大多在句首。



Requirements of a correct sentence



2. The right subject

Common errors--- misplaced subjects/ dangling modifiers (悬垂修饰语)

1) 悬垂分词 (**Dangling participle**)

(误) *Looking up at the sky*, the sun went under a cloud.

(正) *Looking up at the sky*, he saw the sun go under a cloud.

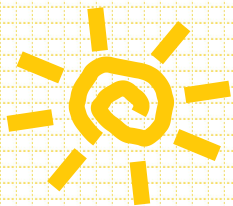
2) 悬垂动名词 (**Dangling gerund**)

(误) After finishing the research, the paper was easy to write.

(正) After finishing the research, I found that the paper was easy to write.



Requirements of a correct sentence



2. The right subject

Common errors--- misplaced subjects/ dangling modifiers (悬垂修饰语)

3) 悬垂动词不定式 (**Dangling infinitive**)

(误) *To write well, good books must be read.*

(正) *To write well, I must read good books.*

4) 悬垂省略从句 (**Dangling elliptical clause**)

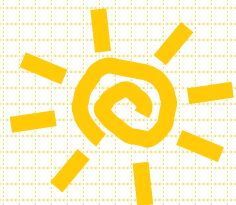
(误) *When only a small boy, my father took me with him to Chicago.*

(正) *When I was only a small boy, my father took me with him to Chicago.*

◆ ★ Subject of a sentence should be properly related to the nonfinite verbs before it.



Requirements of a correct sentence



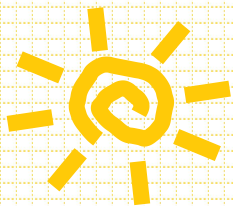
3. Agreement between the subject and the predicate verb

The predicate verb of a sentence has to agree with the subject in person and number. (主谓在人称和数上一致)

- 1) **Collective nouns** like **family** and **audience** may be neither singular or plural, depending on the meaning in which they are used.
- 2) Words, like **news** and names of **branches of learning**, are uncountable, and therefore are always singular; some words, like **people** and **police**, always plural.



Requirements of a correct sentence



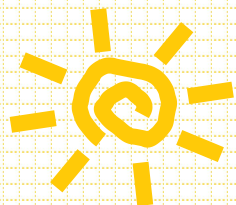
3. Agreement between the subject and the predicate verb

The predicate verb of a sentence has to agree with the subject in person and number. (主谓在人称和数上一致)

- 3) When two subjects refer to different persons or are different in number, **the verb should agree with the subject close to it.**
- 4) Words **together with, in addition to, besides, etc.,** are objects of prepositions; they **do not affect** the number of the subject.
- 5) A subject clause generally takes a singular verb, but **a what-clause which clearly refers to many things** can take a plural verb.



Requirements of a correct sentence



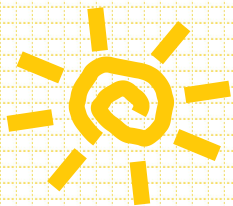
4. agreement between pronoun and antecedent (先行词)

Examples:

- 1) The owner and the captain refused to leave *their* distressed ship.
- 2) The owner and captain refused to leave *his* distressed ship.



Requirements of a correct sentence



4. agreement between pronoun and antecedent (先行词)

Attention!

1) After a compound antecedent with **or, nor, either...or, neither...nor, not only...but also**, a pronoun agrees with the nearer part of the antecedent.

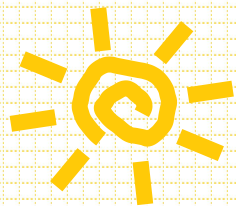
Examples:

Neither the CEO nor his assistant was in **his** office.

Neither the CEO nor his assistants were in **their** office.



Requirements of a correct sentence



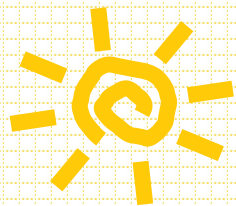
4. agreement between pronoun and antecedent (先行词)

Attention!

2) A singular pronoun follows **a collective noun** antecedent when the members of the group are considered as a unit; a plural pronoun, when they are thought of individually.



Requirements of a correct sentence



4. agreement between pronoun and antecedent (先行词)

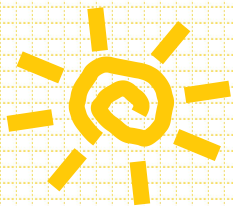
Attention!

(一)不定代词anybody, anyone, each, either, everybody, everyone, neither, no one, nobody, somebody, someone作先行词时, 要求单数的第三人称代词或物主代词与之配合.例如:

Nobody can be sure how *his* children will behave.



Requirements of a correct sentence



4. agreement between pronoun and antecedent (先行词)

Attention!

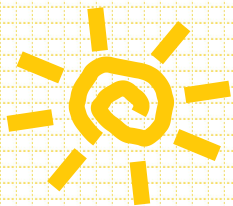
(二) 集体名词作先行词时, 当指一个整体时, 它要求用单数代词与之配合, 如果指整体中的个体时, 要用复数代词形式. 例如:

The troop stopped and made *its* camp.

The entire squad scattered and went *their* separate ways.



Requirements of a correct sentence



4. agreement between pronoun and antecedent (先行词)

Attention!

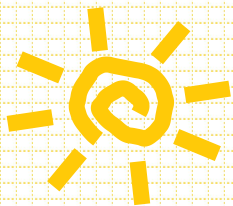
(三) 当存在多个先行词时, 根据就近一致的原则决定哪个是主要的先行词, 再选择代词与之配合。例如:

Either the operators or the supervisor will have *his* license suspended.

Neither Sally nor her roommates have finished *their* work yesterday.



Requirements of a correct sentence



4. agreement between pronoun and antecedent (先行词)

Attention!

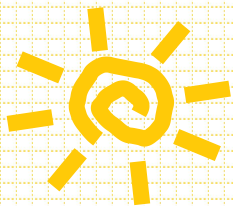
(四) 关系代词who或that出现在one of those who/that 结构中时, 其先行词是those, 因此代词用复数。当关系代词出现在the only one of those who/that结构中时, 其先行词是one, 代词则用复数。

He is only one of our customers who like *their* shirts starched.

He is the only one of our customers who likes *his* shirts starched.



Requirements of a correct sentence



5. clear pronoun reference (指代明确)

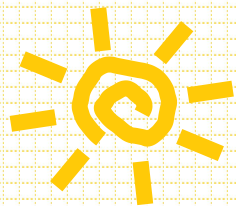
When using personal or relative pronouns(关系代词), make sure their reference is clear so as to avoid ambiguity.

Examples:

- 1) I'm going to the talk on jazz music for he is a well-known composer. (“he” has no antecedent)
- 2) Leave out the word in that sentence because it is too difficult. (2 nouns before “it”)
- 3) She told my sister that her idea was practicable. (“her” may refer to either *her own* or *my sister's*)



Requirements of a correct sentence



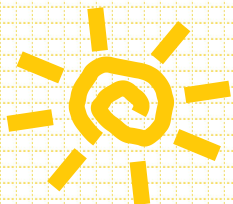
5. clear pronoun reference (指代明确)

大家需要记牢四点：

- 一、代词与其先行项要保持“数”的一致；
- 二、是代词与其先行项要保持“性”的一致；
- 三、是代词与其先行项要保持“人称”的一致；
- 四、是注意代词的格。



Requirements of a correct sentence



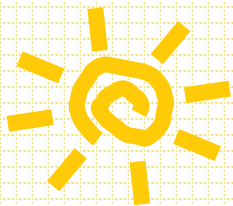
6. ending sentences with full stops

To join two or more complete sentences with commas may be possible in Chinese, but it is wrong in English.

So, we should remember that **a complete declarative sentence always ends with a full stop.**



Requirements of a correct sentence



6. ending sentences with full stops

What's wrong with the following sentences?

- 1) The girls scored higher in math the boys scored higher in verbal skills.
- 2) Education is an elusive word, it often means different things to different people.

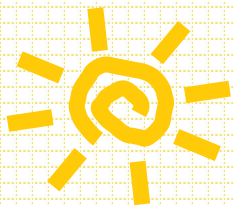
Common errors: run-on sentences(接排句/粘连句) 两个或更多的句子混合交织在一起，而没有正确的标点符号说明它们之间的关系句子。

接排句/粘连句的两种形式:

融合句（**fused sentence**）和逗号连接（**comma splice**）



Requirements of a correct sentence



6. ending sentences with full stops

Fused sentences(融合句)

(误) The girls scored higher in math the boys scored higher in verbal skills.

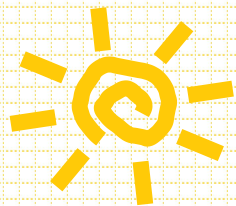
(正) The girls scored higher in math. The boys scored higher in verbal skills.

The girls scored higher in math, *and/but / while* the boys scored higher in verbal skills.

The girls scored higher in math; however, the boys scored higher in verbal skills.



Requirements of a correct sentence



6. ending sentences with full stops

Comma splices(逗号连接，一逗到底)

(误) Education is an elusive word, it often means different things to different people.

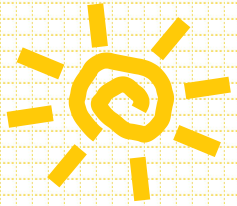
(正) Education is an elusive word. It often means different things to different people.

Education is an elusive word; it often means different things to different people.

Education is an elusive word, *for/ because* it often means different things to different people.



Requirements of a correct sentence



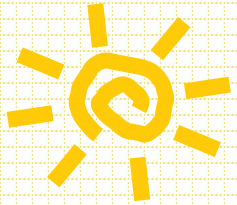
6. ending sentences with full stops

Three ways to correct run-ons:

1. Use a period and a capital letter to separate sentences;
2. Use a comma and a joining word (and, but, for, or, nor, so, yet);
3. Use a semicolon to connect the two complete thoughts



Requirements of a correct sentence



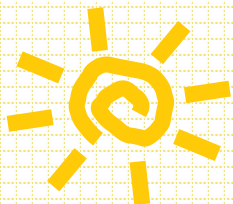
7. joining clauses with conjunctions

When two or more **sentences are closely connected in meaning**, it may be better to put them into one sentence than separate them.

Then those sentences will become clauses which should be joined together with proper *conjunctions* or other words, like relative pronouns.



Requirements of a correct sentence



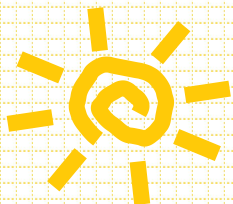
7. joining clauses with conjunctions

Exercises:

- 1) She enjoys listening to pop music, her sister likes classical music better.
- 2) She speaks English fluently, she speaks French quite well.
- 3) The planes for the building are not yet ready, the construction can't start very soon.



Requirements of a correct sentence



7. joining clauses with conjunctions

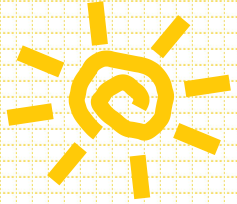
Exercises:

1) She enjoys listening to pop music, her sister likes classical music better.

She enjoys listening to pop music, however her sister likes classical music better.



Requirements of a correct sentence



7. joining clauses with conjunctions

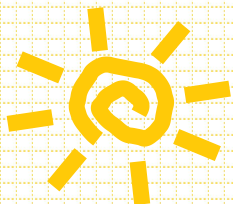
Exercises:

2) She speaks English fluently, she speaks French quite well.

She speaks English fluently, moreover, she speaks French quite well.



Requirements of a correct sentence



7. joining clauses with conjunctions

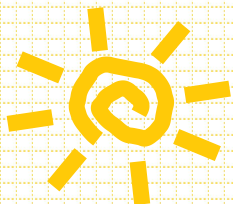
Exercises:

3) The planes for the building are not yet ready, the construction can't start very soon.

The plans for the building are not yet ready, therefore the construction cannot start very soon.



Requirements of a correct sentence



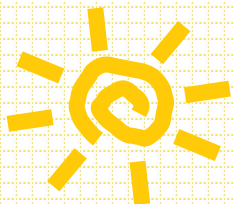
8. a main clause in a complex sentence

★ Note: In a complex sentence, there must be a main clause, whether it is at the beginning or at the end of the sentence.

- 1) He would come to see me whenever he was in this city.
- 2) When she heard the explosion, she called me immediately to ask what **had happened**.
- 3) **Not until** the meeting had come to an end **did they** realize the seriousness of the problem discussed.



Requirements of a correct sentence



8. a main clause in a complex sentence

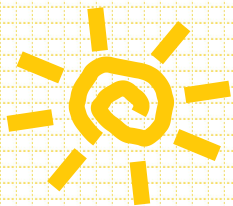
What's wrong in the following?

- 1) Because he had not heard about that important decision.
- 2) Whatever the director said at the conference.
- 3) The man we could find for the job.

Incomplete sentences!



Requirements of a correct sentence



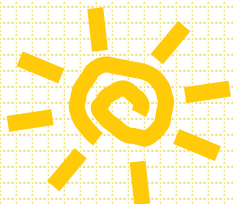
9. Proper use of comparisons

Adjectives or adverbs of the comparative degree should be used *only when there is a comparison*. They are rightly used in the following sentences:

- 1) Sometimes a comparison is implied:
- 2) The meaning of the second sentence is quite clear: this poem is not easier than his other poems.



Requirements of a correct sentence



9. Proper use of comparisons

Tips:

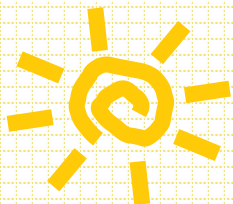
We should **not use** adjectives or adverbs of the comparative degree **when there is no comparison**, explicit or implied.

We should remember that *only things of the same kind can be compared*. The following comparison is not logical:

Her English is much better than I.



Requirements of a correct sentence



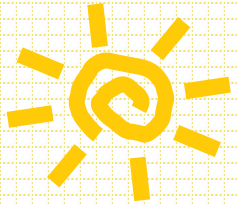
9. Proper use of comparisons

Incorrect comparison:

- 1) He is a better student. (He is a good student/ a fairly good student.)
- 2) The text is easier. (The text is fairly easy/ quite easy.)
- 3) Her English is much better than I. (mine)
- 4) The language of Henry James is more elaborate than (that of) Ernest Hemingway.



Requirements of a correct sentence



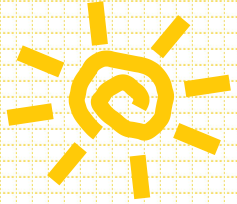
10. correct use of the tenses

◆ *What's wrong with the following?*

- 1) We have revised our work plan last night.
- 2) They changed their timetable and they are working according to it.
- 3) This is his latest novel. Did you read it?
- 4) We are going to the Great Wall. Did you ever go there?
- 5) He has done the work alone and is still doing it.
- 6) He visited all the historical monuments he wanted to see for a long time.



Requirements of a correct sentence



10. correct use of the tenses

Tips:

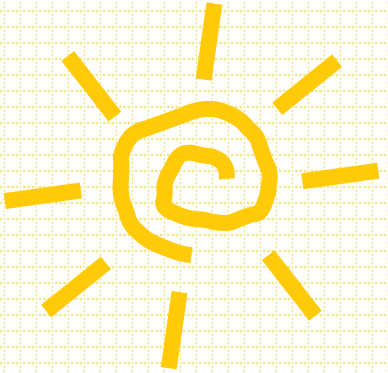
- 1) Whenever we make a sentence, we should ask ourselves **when the thing mentioned in the sentence happens.**
- 2) When we talk about something that **happened in the past, but its result remains at present,** we should use **the present perfect.**



Coordination and Subordination



Coordination



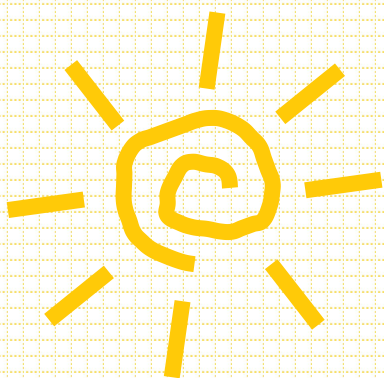
When we mention two or more things or ideas of **equal importance**, we often use coordination clause joined with a coordinating conjunction (and, but, or, nor, yet, so, or, for).



Coordination and Subordination



Coordination



并列句的三种连接方法

- 1) She enjoys listening to pop music, but her sister doesn't. (逗号+连词)
- 2) She enjoys listening to pop music; her sister likes classical music better. (分号)
- 3) She enjoys listening to pop music; however, her sister doesn't like it. (分号+连接副词)



Coordination and Subordination



Coordination

Choose the better way to express:

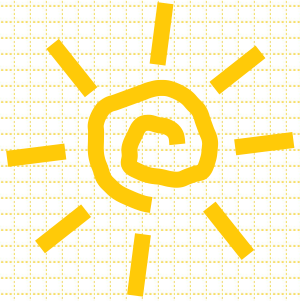
This rich man went to Church every Sunday, **and** he never donated a cent for the benefit of the neighborhood.

This rich man went to Church every Sunday, **but** he never donated a cent for the benefit of the neighborhood.

Although this rich man went to Church every Sunday, he never donated a cent for the benefit of the neighborhood. (✓)

stronger

The best one

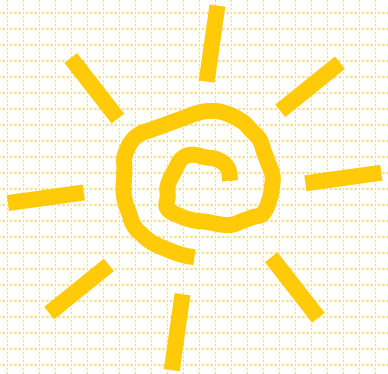




Coordination and Subordination



Subordination



◆ When we express an important idea in a main clause and one or more less important ideas in subordinate clauses, we are using method of subordination.

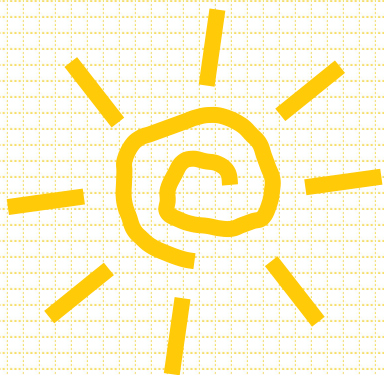
★ the choice of coordination or subordination is mainly decided by the relationship between the ideas to be expressed.



Coordination and Subordination



Subordinate clause



名词性从句:

主语从句 表语从句 宾语从句 同位语从句

定语从句:

限定性定语从句 非限定性定语从句

状语从句

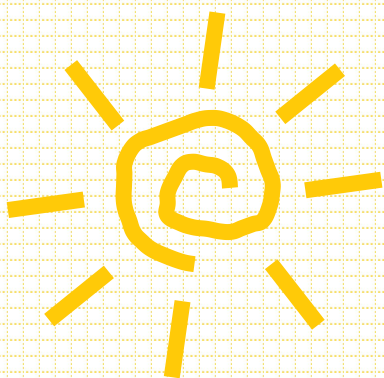
时间、地点、原因、目的、结果、条件、比较、让步、方式状语从句



Coordination and Subordination



Summary



1. 从语意上，两个分句的意义如果具有同等重要性，就可以把它们并列起来。
2. 要在语意上分清主次，突出句子的主要思想，就要使用从属结构，把次要思想置于结构上的从属地位，把主要思想置于结构上的主要地位。



Requirements of an Effective Sentence



Requirements of an effective sentence



- Correct sentences alone can not necessarily make good writing.
- Effective sentences have some or all of the following qualities:

* unity

* coherence

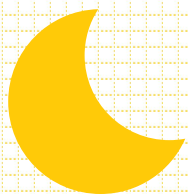
* conciseness

* emphasis

* variety



Requirements of an effective sentence



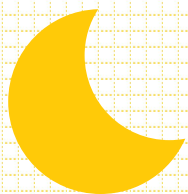
* Unity (整体性, 完整性)

1) A sentence should express a single complete idea, no more, no less. If it contains too much, then the sentence becomes confusing. If it contains too little, then the idea in it is incomplete.

2) In other words, a sentence violates the principle of unity if it contains ideas that are not closely related; what's more, a sentence is not unified if it does not express a complete thought.



Requirements of an effective sentence



* Unity (整体性, 完整性)

There should be a complete idea in a sentence. Sometimes the writer does not provide enough information, and then readers will fail to form a complete piece of information in their mind. So a sentence without a complete idea cannot be effective in real communication.

We can look at the following example:

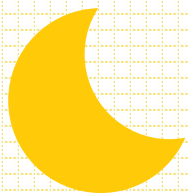
Faulty: *Du Fu was one of the greatest poets.*

Revised: *Du Fu was one of the greatest poets of the Tang period.*



Requirements of an effective sentence

* **Unity** (整体性, 完整性)



More example:

Faulty: *“I got up early. Mom told me that there was always traffic jam **and** our car was a little bit too old and we need buy a new one”.*

Revised: *“I got up early **Monday morning**. Mom told me that there was always **heavy** traffic on Monday mornings, and as our car was a bit old and **couldn't** run fast, we'd better start earlier.”*



Requirements of an effective sentence

* Unity (整体性, 完整性)



Faulty: *Born in a small town in South China in the early 50s, he grew up to be a famous musician.*

Revised: *He was born in a small town in South China in the early 50s. In his childhood he liked to sing songs. Later he entered a conservatory. In the 70s he became a famous musician.*

Analysis: The two parts of the original sentence are **not logically connected**, because a man born in a small town in South China in the early 50s would not necessarily become a famous musician. **Therefore, the sentence lacks unity.** The revised sentences are better, as how and when he became a musician is explained.



Requirements of an effective sentence



* Unity (整体性, 完整性)

- Ideas not closely related:

Faulty: *Born in a small town in South China in 1937, he grew up to be a great musician.*

Revised: *He was born in a small town in South China in 1937, and grew up to be a great musician.*

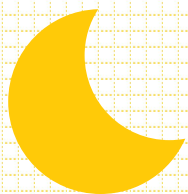
- Idea incomplete:

Faulty: *Dream of the Red Mansion* is the best-known novel.

Revised: *Dream of the Red Mansion* is one of the best-known classical Chinese novel.



Requirements of an effective sentence



* Coherence (逻辑上的连贯性, 一致性)

1) The meaning of English sentences mainly depends on word order, hence, the arrangement of the parts of a sentence is especially important to accurate expression of ideas.

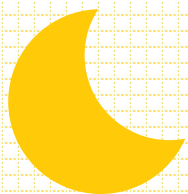
2) Coherence concerns the way the parts of a sentence are linked. It means clear and correct arrangement of the parts of a sentence.

3) Coherence requires that the parts of a sentence are so arranged that they stick together, and that the ideas progress in a logical sequence.

meaning and structure coherence



Requirements of an effective sentence



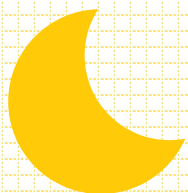
*** Coherence** (逻辑上的连贯性, 一致性)

Here are a few rules which may help to prevent incoherence.

- a. Do not separate words that are closely related unless it is necessary;
- b. Do not use a pronoun with ambiguous reference(指代不明);
- c. Do not make unnecessary or confusing shifts in person or number;
- d. Do not make unnecessary changes in the voice, tense or mood of verbs;
- e. Do not use different forms to express parallel ideas.
- f. Do not use a dangling modifier or put a modifier far from the word it modifies.



Requirements of an effective sentence



* **Coherence** (逻辑上的连贯性, 一致性)

Here are a few rules which may help to prevent incoherence.

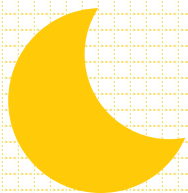
a. Do not separate words that are closely related unless it is necessary;

Faulty: Everyone is studying English in this school.

Revised: Everyone in this school is studying English.



Requirements of an effective sentence



* **Coherence** (逻辑上的连贯性, 一致性)

Here are a few rules which may help to prevent incoherence.

b. Do not use a pronoun with ambiguous reference(指代不明);

Faulty: Mrs. Green said to her sister that she had done the right thing.

Revised: Mrs Green said to her sister, “You have done the right thing.”

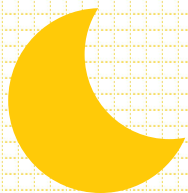
Mrs Green said to her sister, “I have done the right thing.”

Mrs Green thought that her sister had done the right thing and said to her.

Mrs Green thought she herself had done the right thing and said it to her sister.



Requirements of an effective sentence



* **Coherence** (逻辑上的连贯性, 一致性)

Here are a few rules which may help to prevent incoherence.

c. Do not make unnecessary or confusing shifts in person or number;

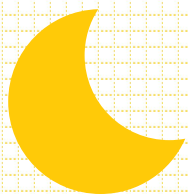
- 1) Those who want to take PETS-5 sign your name on this sheet of paper (their).
- 2) **Faulty**: The explosion destroyed the building and a number of people were injured.

Revised: The explosion destroyed the building and injured a number of people.

Or: In the explosion the building was destroyed and a number of people were injured.



Requirements of an effective sentence



* **Coherence** (逻辑上的连贯性, 一致性)

Here are a few rules which may help to prevent incoherence.

d. Do not make unnecessary changes in the voice, tense or mood of verbs;

Faulty: A lot of high houses **were built** around hers in the past few years and she **gets** no more sunlight.

Revised: A lot of high houses **have been built** around hers in the past few

Or: A lot of high houses **were built** around hers in the past few years and she **got** no more sunlight.



Requirements of an effective sentence



* **Coherence** (逻辑上的连贯性, 一致性)

Here are a few rules which may help to prevent incoherence.

e. Do not use different forms to express parallel ideas.

Faulty: It is generally believed that one's action is more important than what one says.

Revised: It is generally believed that one's action is more important than **one's words**.

Faulty: The young man is honest and hardworking, and is a very reliable worker.

Revised: The young man is **an** honest, hardworking and reliable **worker**.

Or: The young man is honest, hardworking and **reliable**.



Requirements of an effective sentence



* **Coherence** (逻辑上的连贯性, 一致性)

Here are a few rules which may help to prevent incoherence.

f. Don't use a dangling modifier or put a modifier far from the word it modifies;

Faulty: Looking out of the window, only dull grey buildings can be seen.

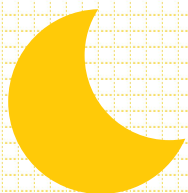
Revised: Looking out of the window, I (we, you, he...) can see only dull grey buildings.

Faulty: After studying Lesson Ten, the mid-term test was given to us.

Revised: After studying Lesson Ten, we had the mid-term test.



Requirements of an effective sentence



* **Coherence** (逻辑上的连贯性, 一致性)

Attention!

In short, coherence is essential to the accurate and clear expression of ideas.

So it is a good habit to reread the sentences we have written to see whether they are coherent, and make necessary changes if they are not.



Requirements of an effective sentence



* Conciseness (简洁性)

- 1) One of the rules of sentence-making is **to use only the necessary words, or as few words as possible** so long as the meaning is fully expressed.
- 2) Conciseness means that effective sentence should not contain unnecessary words, that is, there should not be any word in the sentence that does not add something to the information. These redundant words can only cover up the real meaning and confuse your readers.



Requirements of an effective sentence



* Conciseness (简洁性)

The following are some examples of lack of conciseness.

The flower is red in color.

The war ended in the year of 1945.

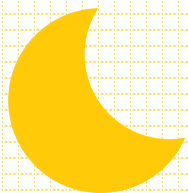
Professor Smith is a very learned and kind professor.

In my opinion, I think the second plan is better.



Requirements of an effective sentence

* Conciseness (简洁性)



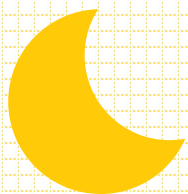
A few hints for concise and clear sentences:

- a. use a pronoun instead of repeating a noun;
- b. use a word instead of a phrase with the same meaning, and use a phrase instead of a clause with the same meaning;
- c. do not repeat words or phrase, if possible, in a sentence or in one that follows;
- d. do not use different words or phrase with similar meanings in the same sentence;
- e. do not repeat the same idea in different sentences except for emphasis.



Requirements of an effective sentence

* Conciseness (简洁性)



■ **Wordiness** also violates the principle of unity, the idea gets blurred by unnecessary words which obscure it like clouds and smoke.

Examples:

Wordy: Sorry, I'm not in a position to offer assistance to him.

Concise: Sorry, I am unable to help him.

Wordy: The maid put the letter that came from Prague on my desk.

Concise: The maid put the letter from Prague on my desk.

Wordy: There are several advantages to buying a motorbike.

Concise: Buying a motorbike offers several advantages.

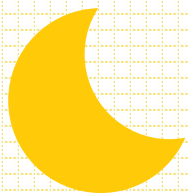
Wordy: I'd like to take the opportunity to say thank you.

Concise: Thank you.



Requirements of an effective sentence

* Conciseness (简洁性)



More examples:

① **Wordy**: He gave many reasons for the failure, but the reasons he gave were not convincing.

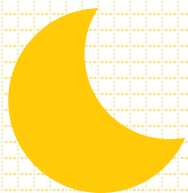
Concise: He gave many reasons for the failure which were not convincing.

Or: He gave many reasons for the failure, but none of them were convincing.



Requirements of an effective sentence

* Conciseness (简洁性)



More examples:

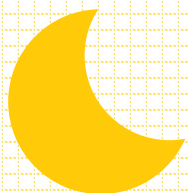
② **Wordy**: The woman who is dressed in black over there is the person who is now in charge of our sales department.

Concise: The woman in black over there is in charge of our sales department.

Or: The woman in black over there is the manager of our sales department.



Requirements of an effective sentence



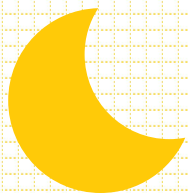
* Emphasis (强调性)

When we talk, we emphasize an important idea by **raising our voices or making a gesture**. When we write, we also **have ways** to lay emphasis on certain words or phrases.



Requirements of an effective sentence

* Emphasis (强调性)



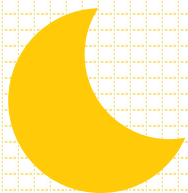
Ways of making emphasis:

- 1) Head and end placing
- 2) Climactic sequence
- 3) The use of verbs in the active voice
- 4) Subordination
- 5) Repeating important words
- 6) Short sentences
- 7) Balanced sentences
- 8) Periodic sentences
- 9) Negative-positive statements
- 10) Rhetorical questions
- 11) Other ways of emphasis



Requirements of an effective sentence

* Emphasis (强调性)



Ways of making emphasis:

1) Head and end placing

The **end and the beginning** of a sentence usually attract the reader's attention, so important elements of a sentence should be put at these two places, **especially the end**.

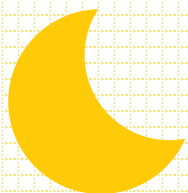
Example:

He will not have the endurance needed for the long training required to be a dentist, I think.



Requirements of an effective sentence

* Emphasis (强调性)



Ways of making emphasis:

1) Head and end placing

More examples:

Only Qian Wen could have written such a nice essay, though there are fifty students in the class.

Of the fifty students in the class, no one could have written such a nice essay but Qian Wen. (emphasized)

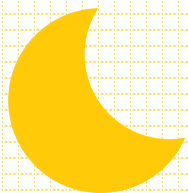
What was common to all heroes was that they did not fear death, danger or hardships.

What was common to all heroes was that they did not fear hardships, danger or death. (emphasized)



Requirements of an effective sentence

* Emphasis (强调性)



Ways of making emphasis:

2) Climactic sequence

In enumerating things or ideas, we should start from the least important and end with the most important.

Examples:

① A biologist once said the ant is a symbol of wisdom, industry and efficiency.

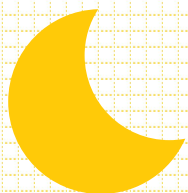
② This tourist group visited the Great Wall, the Summer Palace, the Palace museum, and the Zoo while they were in Beijing.

③ He said he had lost interest in life, fame, position and money after that tragedy.



Requirements of an effective sentence

* Emphasis (强调性)



Ways of making emphasis:

2) Climactic sequence

Examples:

① A biologist once said the ant is a symbol of wisdom, industry and efficiency.

A biologist once said that ant is a symbol of efficiency, industry and wisdom.

(emphasized)



Requirements of an effective sentence

* Emphasis (强调性)



Ways of making emphasis:

2) Climactic sequence

Examples:

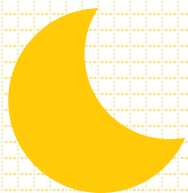
② This tourist group visited the Great Wall, the Summer Palace, the Palace museum, and the Zoo while they were in Beijing.

This tourist group, while in Beijing, visited the Zoo, the Summer Palace, the Palace Museum, and the Great Wall. (**emphasized**)



Requirements of an effective sentence

* Emphasis (强调性)



Ways of making emphasis:

2) Climactic sequence

Examples:

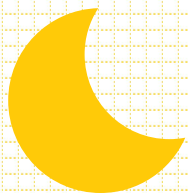
③ He said he had lost interest in life, fame, position and money after that tragedy.

He said that after that tragedy he had lost interest in money, fame, position, and life. (emphasized)



Requirements of an effective sentence

* Emphasis (强调性)



Ways of making emphasis:

3) The use of verbs in the active voice

Verbs are generally more emphatic than nouns or any other part of speech.

Example:

She made a decision that she would not take the job.

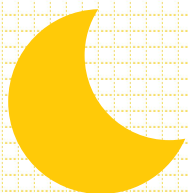
She decided not to take the job. (emphasized)

She decided that she would not take the job. (emphasized)



Requirements of an effective sentence

* Emphasis (强调性)



Ways of making emphasis:

3) The use of verbs in the active voice

Verbs are generally more emphatic than nouns or any other part of speech.

More examples:

Television was watched by the whole family in the evenings.

The whole family watched television in the evenings. (**emphasized**)

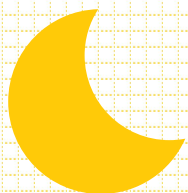
But,

All the buildings in this block have been pulled down and new houses will be built next year. (**the receivers of the actions are emphasized**)



Requirements of an effective sentence

* Emphasis (强调性)



Ways of making emphasis:

4) Subordination

Subordinating a part of a sentence is a way of giving emphasis to the main idea in the sentence.

Example:

Fourth-year students often work in the school library. The school library contains a large number of English books.

Fourth-year students often work in the school library, where there are a large number of English books. (the idea in the main clause is emphasized)



Requirements of an effective sentence

* Emphasis (强调性)



Ways of making emphasis:

4) Subordination

Subordinating a part of a sentence is a way of giving emphasis to the main idea in the sentence.

More examples:

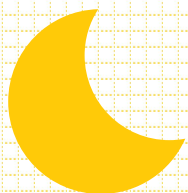
A plane is wheeling over the city, producing a big noise that surprised the inhabitants. (the main part is emphasized)

Putting a pile of books on the counter, the librarian said to her, “Here are all the books on your topic.” (the main part is emphasized)



Requirements of an effective sentence

* Emphasis (强调性)



Ways of making emphasis:

5) Repeating important words

Repetition as a rule should be avoided, but occasionally important words can be repeated for the sake of emphasis.

Examples:

Her spoken English is good; her written English is also good.

Two days ago he gave reasons for supporting the plan, and now he is giving reasons for opposing it. He always has reasons.

He was the first of the group to rush into a burning house to rescue an old lady, and he was also the first to jump into a river to save a drowning child.



Requirements of an effective sentence

* Emphasis (强调性)



Ways of making emphasis:

6) Short sentences

Short sentences are often emphatic, especially after longer ones.

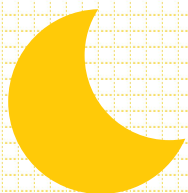
Example:

The speaker asked the audience what they thought were main problems the city government was facing, and how these problems should or could be solved, and he eagerly waited for answers. No answer came. (the short sentence emphasized, especially after longer ones)



Requirements of an effective sentence

* Emphasis (强调性)



Ways of making emphasis:

7) Balanced sentences

A balanced sentence is one that consists of two parts of the same structure and roughly the same length, and with contrasted (or similar) ideas.

Examples:

The gentleman values harmony, not uniformity; the small man values uniformity, not harmony.

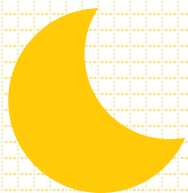
He likes smoking; his wife hates it.

It is not easy to be like everyone else; it is harder to be different from everyone else.



Requirements of an effective sentence

* Emphasis (强调性)



Ways of making emphasis:

8) Periodic sentences

A periodic sentence is one that is not complete in structure or meaning until it reaches the last word, which is the most important word of the sentence.)

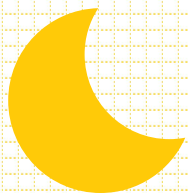
Examples:

- ① He said for buying a house he had prepared everything but money.
- ② It is generally acknowledged that the sole criterion of truth is practice.
- ③ She often said to her parents and friends that her greatest wish was to be an artist.



Requirements of an effective sentence

* Emphasis (强调性)



Ways of making emphasis:

9) Negative-positive statements

When a negative statement is followed by a positive one, the meaning is emphasized by the contrast.

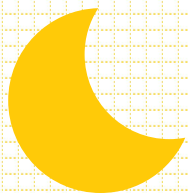
Examples:

- ① He no longer wants money; he wants fame.
- ② The poor design of the building shows that he is not an architect —he is only a builder.
- ③ He is not an ordinary scholar in this field; he is an authority.



Requirements of an effective sentence

* Emphasis (强调性)



Ways of making emphasis:

10) Rhetorical questions 反问句

Rhetorical questions are questions in form but emphatic statements in meaning. They are not asked to be answered.

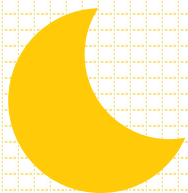
Examples:

- ① Didn't I tell you not to come late?
- ② What's the use of the feeling sorry about the mistake? Correct it.
- ③ Isn't it beautiful weather?



Requirements of an effective sentence

* Emphasis (强调性)



Ways of making emphasis:

11) Other ways of emphasis

the use of emphatic expressions such as:

above all

extremely

by far

It is ... that ...

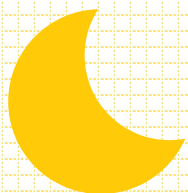
What ... !

How ...!

the use of punctuation marks.



Requirements of an effective sentence

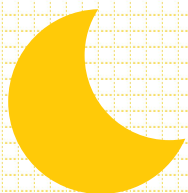


* Variety (多样性)

A series of sentences of the same structure and length with the same noun or pronoun as the subjects may produce monotony. It is often good to vary structures and mix short and long, simple and compound or complex, loose and periodic sentences, so long as the meaning is properly expressed.



Requirements of an effective sentence



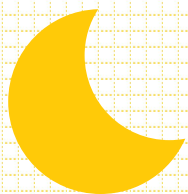
* Variety (多样性)

Examples:

I am Wang Jun. I am thirteen. I am a student in No. 1 Middle School. I get up at 6:00 everyday. I go to school at 7:30. I study Chinese, English, Mathematics, geography and history. I like these courses. I like English most.



Requirements of an effective sentence



* Avoid Chinglish (中式英语)

Chinglish, or Chinese English, refers to written or spoken English influenced by the Chinese language, culture or contexts.

Chinglish may be **grammatically acceptable**, but it is **not in accord with English linguistic and cultural norms**.

Examples:

永远记住你 ② remember you forever ③ always remember you (没有人能活到forever)

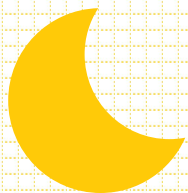
给你 ② give you ③ here you are

很喜欢... ② very like ... ③ like ... very much

祝你有个... ② wish you have a ... ③ I wish you



Requirements of an effective sentence



* Avoid Chinglish (中式英语)

Major causes of Chinglish:

- 1) the misuse of words
- 2) the misuse of collocations
- 3) redundancy
- 4) improper grammar
- 5) cultural differences
- 6) Differences between Chinese and English modes of thinking

